CONTRACT CHECKLIST

Five clauses every freelance contract needs. Check each one before you sign or send.

- [ ] **Scope**
  Exactly what's included, and what isn't.
  Example: "A five-page website: Home, About, Services, Reviews, Contact. Copywriting and photography are not included."

- [ ] **Revisions**
  How many rounds, and what extra rounds cost.
  Example: "Two rounds of revisions per page. Additional rounds are billed at $__ per hour."

- [ ] **Payment**
  50% up front, the rest on delivery, with due dates.
  Example: "50% deposit to begin. Remaining 50% due on launch, payable within 14 days."

- [ ] **Ownership**
  Rights transfer when the final invoice is paid.
  Example: "All rights to the final design transfer to the client once the final invoice is paid in full."

- [ ] **Kill fee**
  What you're owed if they cancel partway through. (In my opinion, not always necessary.)
  Example: "If the project is cancelled after work begins, the deposit is non-refundable and completed work is billed at $__."

WHEN THEY SAY "I CAN GET IT CHEAPER"

"He probably can, and that might be the right call. *What made you reach out to me?*"

Don't defend your value and don't drop your price. Listen: their answer is your value, in their words. If the budget really is lower, cut the scope, not the price.

RED FLAGS: PASS ON THE PROJECT

- They can't explain the problem they want solved.
- They haggle before you've started.
- They want free samples to "see if you're a fit," including in a hiring process.